6 Summer Remedies

Compiled from Experiences of Dr Alpesh Oza

Founder and CEO of Homeosetu

And other Stalwarts tips enclosed

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KALI BICHROMICUM

Origin / Chemistry

Potassium bichromate — a chromium salt found in cement, welding fumes, leather tanning, and anti-dust paints. Chromium salts are known to cause allergic reactions and mucosal destruction.

Pathogenesis

Factory workers exposed to chromium fumes developed:

- Increased watery nasal secretions **aggravated by open air**
- Soreness, redness, fetid smell
- Progressive nasal obstruction
- **Destruction of nasal bones**
- Loss of smell
  Accidental ingestion produced **severe gastric irritation** with **heaviness** (not pain) in the epigastrium.
  Mucous membranes become dry, tenacious; posterior nasal discharge often passes into the throat and stomach.

Key Clinical Picture

- Subacute/indolent nasal & sinus complaints

- Thick, tenacious, often fetid secretions
- Patient presents after 2–4 days of self-treatment
- One-sided fixed headaches
- Heaviness in epigastrium
- Cough provoked by eating
- Attempts to blow nose but little discharge

Peculiar Repertory Rubrics

- Knerr - Nose; Blowing; hard substance, sensation of a, compelling to blow, but no discharge(1) : 3 kali-bi.
- Knerr - Nose; Bones; pressure, with dry feeling in nose(1) : kali-bi. (3 marks)
- Knerr - Nose; Dryness; nasal bones, with pressure in(1) : kali-bi. (4 marks)
- Knerr - Nose; Heat; air, expired feels hot(1) : kali-bi. (4 marks)
- Knerr - Nose; Stopped; upper part, especially, difficulty of detaching thick mucus, which more readily passes by posterior nares(1) : kali-bi. (4 marks)
- Knerr Repertory- Nose; Coryza; lumpy; tough, small, greater part, and ropy, passes down posterior nares into throat, and is hawked up with difficulty and disgust(1) : kali-bi.(3 marks)
- Knerr Repertory- Nose; Posterior nares; mucus, tough, ropy, passes into throat(1) : kali-bi.(3 marks)

Differential Diagnosis

- **Arsenicum album** — thin, acrid discharges; anxiety
- **Antimonium tartaricum** — rattling chest, copious mucus
- **Croton tiglium** — skin & GI sphere
- **Bromium / Iodum / Spongia** — larynx/trachea
- **Mercurius / Phytolacca** — bone/periosteal involvement

Prescribing Tips

- Subacute nasal/sinus cases after failed home remedies
- 30C–200C for acute/subacute
- 200C–1M for deeper or recurrent cases
- Allow time for action in indolent cases

Clinical Vignette

Chromium-exposed workers developed watery nasal discharge → soreness → fetid smell → obstruction → bone destruction — a classic Kali-bich pattern.

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Golden Tip from Dr Roger Morrison

Morrison says - the patient may focus more on his physical pathology than mental disturbances. So when his material Needs are not met, he will get irritable and gloomy.

ANTIMONIUM CRUDUM

Origin / Chemistry

Antimony trisulfide — half metal, half sulfur; produces mixed metallic + sulfuric symptomatology.

Pathogenesis

- Depressed vitality of mucous membranes
- Thick white tongue coating
- Sluggish digestion
- Lumpy/curdy secretions
- Overflow phenomena: nausea, vomiting, diarrhoea
- Skin sluggish to clear debris

Key Clinical Picture

- Heavy white tongue coating
- Sluggish digestion, flatulence, fullness
- Lumpy mucus, curdy discharges
- Seen in extremes of life (young/old)
- Irritability; "crude" mental state
- Gastric complaints after cold drinks or overeating in summer

Peculiar Repertory Rubrics

- Knerr - Stomach; Fullness; eaten, as after having, too much(5) : 3 ant-c.
- Knerr - Stomach; Eating; abdomen; flatulence, wind does not pass(1) : ant-c.

Differential Diagnosis

- **Arsenicum album** — thin, burning discharges
- **Bryonia** — dryness, stitching pains
- **Pulsatilla** — bland, changeable discharges
- **Squilla** — complementary in mucous states

Prescribing Tips

- Acute mucous overload: 30C–200C

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- Chronic sluggish mucous states: 200C+
- Monitor tongue coating and digestion

Clinical Vignette

After cold drinks/overeating in summer, patients developed thick white tongue, nausea, lumpy mucus — classic Ant-crud.

SINAPIS NIGRA

Origin / Chemistry

Black mustard; contains sinigrin → mustard oil glycoside (mucous membrane irritant).

Pathogenesis

- Alternating dryness and thick secretions
- Obstruction at root of nose
- Night sneezing when lying down
- Stoppage with profuse discharge

Key Clinical Picture

- Alternating dryness ↔ profuse discharge
- Night sneezing
- Root-of-nose obstruction
- Hot sensations in nasal passages

Peculiar Repertory Rubrics

- Knerr - Nose; Coryza; acrid; profuse; thin, watery(1) : sin-n.(2 marks)
- Knerr - Nose; Dryness; nostril, worse in left(2) : sin-n. (3 marks)
- Knerr - Nose; Stopped; nostrils, feeling as if, although discharge profuse, thin mucus excoriating nose and lip(1) : sin-n (2 marks).
- Kent - Nose; Obstruction; sensation of; with watery discharge(12) : sin-n.
- Kent - Nose; Obstruction; sensation of; with watery discharge(12) : sin-n.
- Kent - Nose; Sneezing; night; lying down, while(1) : sin-n.
- Kent - Nose; Obstruction; root, at(8) : sin-n.
- Kent - Nose; Dryness; inside; alternating with discharge; sides(1) : sin-n.

Differential Diagnosis

- **Kali bichromicum** — tenacious, lumpy mucus
- **Pulsatilla** — bland, changeable discharges

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- **Nux vomica** — digestive triggers

Prescribing Tips

- 30C–200C for acute nasal obstruction
- Repeat as needed
- Think Sinapis when dryness alternates with thick discharge

Clinical Vignette

Night sneezing + alternating dryness/thick discharge + root-of-nose obstruction = classic Sinapis.

IPECAC (IPECACUANHA)

Origin / Chemistry

Short-acting remedy for spasmodic respiratory & gastric states.

Pathogenesis

- Profuse secretions
- Nausea with clean/moist tongue
- Vomiting that does not relieve
- Spasmodic cough with weather change
- Immediate reaction to cold
- Short duration → frequent repetition needed

Key Clinical Picture

- Clean, moist tongue with persistent nausea
- Vomiting without relief
- Spasmodic cough with mucus
- Irritability in acute phase
- Seasonal/periodic recurrence

Peculiar Repertory Rubrics

- Kent - Respiration; Difficult; change of weather(2)
- Kent - Respiration; Difficult; cold; after taking(4)
- CR24 - Generalities; summer; agg.; every(1)
- Boericke - Aggravation; Temperature, extremes of(3) : ip. (other rx- ant c,lach)

Differential Diagnosis

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- **Chamomilla** — irritability (Ipecac helps when Chamomilla fails)
- **Arsenicum / Phosphorus** — severe vomiting
- **Antimonium tartaricum** — mucus vs. vomiting differentiation

Prescribing Tips

- 30C–200C for acute
- Severe respiratory spasms: 1M hourly
- Stop when improvement begins
- Short-acting; not constitutional

Golden Observations from provings

Symptoms of Ipecac develop in this order:

(1) Gastric,

(2) Respiratory

(3) Spinal,

(4) Genito-urinary,

(5) Cutaneous.

Golden Points From Dr NASH

The respiratory troubles have two conditions:

1st. Those in which excessive accumulation of mucus characterized the case.

2d. Those in which spasm was the characteristic feature.

COLOCYNTHIS

Origin / Chemistry

Classical remedy for violent colic and cramping pains.

Pathogenesis

- Sudden, severe cramping pains
- Twisting, drawing, radiating pains
- Relief from bending double or pressure
- Triggered by cold nights/hot days or after eating
- Profuse urination during attacks

Key Clinical Picture

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- Violent colic relieved by bending double
- Sudden stools after eating/drinking
- Pain radiating or extending
- Profuse urination during attacks

Peculiar Repertory Rubrics

- Kent - Abdomen; Pain; aching, dull pain; drinking; when overheated(3) (Ars, Colo, kali carb)
- Kent - Abdomen; Pain; cramping; umbilicus, region of; diarrhoea, before(2)
- Kent - Abdomen; Fullness, sensation of; supper, after(6)
- Kent - Abdomen; Heaviness, as from a load, etc; supper, after(2)
- Kent - Abdomen; Movements in; hypogastrium; after dinner, after stool(1)
- Kent - Abdomen; Pain; aching, dull pain; hypogastrium; stool; after(5)

Differential Diagnosis

- **Nux vomica** — colic after stimulants
- **Bryonia** — stitching pains
- **China** — colic with exhaustion
- **Magnesia / Elaps** — specific modalities

Prescribing Tips

- Acute severe colic: 200C–1M
- Repeat half-hourly until relief
- Bending-double modality is key

Clinical Vignette

Transition season (cold nights/hot days) → sudden cramping colic relieved by bending forward.

Golden Tips from Provings

All Provers - No Effect after first dose for few hours.

The symptoms appeared in groups, and were aggravated in evening and during rest.

One Prover - Showed Loose Stools followed by abdominal Pains followed by Profuse urination.

Second Prover - Never had Anal haemorrhage but after Colocynthis had it for one year even after stopping it.

Golden Tip from Boericke

Often indicated in the transition season when the air is cold, but the sun is still powerful enough to heat the blood.

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SULPHUR

Origin / Chemistry

Classical Polychrest ; all rounder/ acute/chronic/finisher/intercurrent remedy.

Pathogenesis

- Complaints improve then remain stationary or relapse
- Yearly periodic eruptions
- Vesicular confluent eruptions
- Chronic skin complaints recurring in summer
- Heat, burning, itching

Key Clinical Picture

- Recurrent summer eruptions
- Burning/itching skin
- Hot palms/soles
- Relapse after acute remedies

Peculiar Repertory Rubrics

- Boericke - Generalities; Complaints; improve then remain stationary(3)
- Boericke - Generalities; Complaints; improve then relapse continually(1)
- Boericke - Generalities; Inflammations; passive(4)

Differential Diagnosis

- Other sulphur/miasmatic polychrests
- Use after acute remedies when relapse occurs

Prescribing Tips

- Acute skin: 6C–30C hourly
- Intercurrent: 200C–1M
- Use as finisher when acute remedies suppress but do not cure

Clinical Tips

Sulphur prevents recurrence of seasonal eruptions and consolidates cure after acute remedies.

Golden Tips from Dr Clarke

CLARKE -mentions sulphur as only rx in hot palms and soles.. Or vertex hot..

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